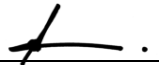


SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods , plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	CONCRETE CUT OFF SAW - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Signature: _____ 			
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> Phone	<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date
		<u></u> Signature	

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training of operator	An untrained operator is a danger to himself and others	1	1. All persons working on site must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card. 2. All persons working on site must be suitably trained and competent in the task they are to perform. 3. Workers completing works to be adequately supervised. 4. Make sure the operator is familiar with the supplier's safe use manual and is able to operate the equipment to the supplier's recommendations. 5. Make sure the operator understands what the hazards associated with the cutting operation are, why the risks need to be controlled and how the risks are to be controlled. 6. Make sure the operator understands what protective equipment is needed, why it is needed, and how it is to be fitted and used.	Management Supervisor	2
The protection of other workers and the public.	Flying debris	1	1. Barricades and signs may be needed to warn people who may be at risk from the cutting operation.	Supervisor	2
The type and condition of the concrete	Obstructions or resistance in the material being cut – can cause sudden kick-back, pushback or pull-in movements of the saw.	1	Does it contain reinforcing steel, electrical cable conduits, gas pipes or other services? 1. Services plans should be checked to ensure that live services will not be cut by the saw.	Supervisor	2
	Confined spaces Carbon monoxide	1	1. Petrol driven equipment should not be used in confined spaces because of the potential for carbon monoxide poisoning.	Supervisor	2
	Electrocution	1	1. If electrical equipment is used in wet conditions, the potential for electrocution needs to be considered and be guarded against.	Supervisor	2
Personal Protective Equipment	Cuts Noise (hearing loss) Dust Flying debris	3	Operators of cutting machines must wear 1. Safety helmet where applicable; 2. Safety footwear; 3. Safety goggles; 4. Face shield; 5. Hearing protection; 6. Sun and weather protection; 7. Gloves to improve grip and reduce force and vibration; and	Operator	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			8. Respiratory protection -P2 Dust Mask		
Using the equipment Setting Up	Cuts Manual handling sprains and strains Noise (hearing loss) Vibration (circulatory damage) Electricity (electric shock) Surfaces slippery from cutting residue (falls, sprains) Dust	1	When setting up a cutting operation, make sure that: 1. The exact location of the cut or penetration is clearly marked on the work area 2. A trolley is used to support the cutting machine for horizontal work at low level, so that operators do not have to work on their knees. 3. The cutting blade is the right size and right type for the machine 4. The blade is in good working condition and is free from cracks and deterioration 5. Electrically powered machines are protected at the power outlet with a residual current device (earth leakage circuit breaker). 6. Appropriate barricading and warning signs are erected to prevent people entering the cutting area. 7. Adequate lighting (natural or artificial) is provided at the work area. 8. A method of collecting residue from the cutting operation is put in place in order to prevent surfaces becoming slippery.	Operator	2
Before cutting operation	Cuts Manual handling sprains and strains Noise (hearing loss) Vibration (circulatory damage) Electricity (electric shock) Surfaces slippery from cutting residue (falls, sprains) Dust	1	1. The general condition of the equipment should be checked by the person doing the cutting before commencing each job to ensure that the cutting tool, guards, leads and hydraulic hoses are in good order. 2. Make sure that equipment with defects which would endanger people is not to be used. (Tag out). Before cutting operation, check that: 1. The cutting speed matches the drive speed, as per the manufacturer's specification. 2. The shaft and flanges are clean and not damaged. 3. The blade fits securely over the shaft. 4. The shaft nut is securely tightened against the outside flange. 5. A blade guard is fitted and is in good working order. 6. The drive belt is tensioned correctly. 7. Adequate coolant or water is readily available for wet cutting.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
During the cutting operation	Cuts Manual handling sprains and strains Noise (hearing loss) Vibration (circulatory damage) Electricity (electric shock) Surfaces slippery from cutting residue (falls, sprains) Dust	1	During cutting operation, make sure that: 1. The blade guard is in the lowered position. 2. When starting the machine the operator and other people stand outside the path of the blade. 3. If the machine stalls during cutting operation, the blade is raised and the outside flange and nut are checked for tightness. 4. Whenever blade is raised, when resuming cutting, the blade is in alignment with the previous cut. 5. Wall cuts are performed with the operator's back close to vertical and the hands not move above shoulder height. 6. Where possible, cut from a standing posture with the feet braced and the body balanced. (In some circumstances it may be necessary to kneel on one knee to enable cuts to be made close to the floor. In this situation, protection for the knee will be necessary) 7. When cutting horizontally across a wall, the operator's hands are at waist height 8. The length of time the operator spends in fixed postures is minimised. 9. Plenty of water or coolant is used to suppress dust at the point of generation. (Failure to use coolant/water could create high levels of airborne dust that contains crystalline silica in concentrations to be a significant health hazard). 10. The throttle lock is only be used when starting the equipment. If the throttle lock used during normal operation then the ability to cut power will be reduced increasing the potential for injury. 11. The equipment is stopped when changing grip to move between horizontal and vertical cuts. 12. The handles provided are used to support the equipment. (Supporting the equipment by the belt guard is poor work practice and should be avoided). 13. When using electrical equipment the electrical leads will not be cut during operation. It is also possible that the presence of water (either coolant or rainwater etc) could lead to electrocution.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			14. Any person, who is providing assistance to the operator, is located where they will not be exposed to danger from sudden saw movement, ejection of material, a dropped machine or falling offcuts. 15. The saw is only used with blade rotating in the opposite direction to the cut and not used for inverted cutting.		
	Working Alone	1	1. Do not work alone as this can be hazardous because of the potential need to provide assistance to the operator in the event of an unsafe incident or emergency situation.	Supervisor Operator	2
Maintenance	Various	1	1. The equipment should be inspected and maintained regularly by a competent person.	Supervisor	2
Clean Up	Various	2	1. All concrete waste to be removed from site or where there are only small amounts these can be placed in the bins/cages provided.	Operator	3
Using mobile plant to clear site Excavator/ Trucks	Striking workers, pedestrians or other plant and equipment.	1	1. Plant to have flashing light and reversing beeper operating or travel alarm. 2. Plant work area to be barricaded off if necessary. 3. Comply with speed limits on and around building site. 4. Operate only in designated access routes. 5. Do not park plant where it will create a hazard to public vehicles, pedestrians or other workers. 6. High visibility shirts to be worn by workers when in close proximity to plant. 7. No work within 2m of an open trench or shaft unless barricades are in place. All trenches and excavations must be barricaded if left unattended.	Operator	2
	Plant failure	1	1. Plant to be properly maintained and checked before use. 2. Operator to wear seat belt. 3. Ensure roll over protection structure is in good working condition. 4. Ensure safety pins are fitted into quick hitch. 5. When lifting the correct certified lifting gear must be used. 6. Regularly maintain plant and machinery to manufacturer's requirements. Plant maintenance and logbook details to be kept current.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Striking of services.	1	1. Determine where existing underground services are on plans. 2. Use Dial-Before-U-Dig services. 3. Set work limits around services. 4. A certified spotter is to be used when working within 3m-6.4m of power lines. 5. The area within 3m of power lines is a no go zone.	Operator	2
	Overturning or tipping of plant / Unstable ground.	1	1. Competent/ licensed operators only to use plant. 2. Only operate plant on stable ground. 3. A visual assessment is to be done on the ground conditions prior to commencing work. 4. Un-battered excavations are to be barricaded off. 5. Batter back, bench or shore unstable ground if required.	Operator	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment – P2	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card					
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management		
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training		

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2012

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Managing the risks of respirable crystalline silica from engineered stone in the workplace 2023			

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.

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